Economic Importance of The Family Musaceae

S.No	Economic importance	Binomial	Useful part	Uses
1	**Food plant**	*Musa paradisiaca*	The raw (tender green) bananas, the shaft and male buds. Leaves Fruit	Cooked and eaten as vegetable. Commonly used as plates on festive occasions and are widely used to wrap food items when cooking. Crunchy and salty fried plantain chips are delicious.
		Ensete ventricosum	Flower stalk (Shaft)	Edible after cooking.
		Musa chinensis (Chinea kela)	Fruits	Edible bananas which are sweet, rich in starch and vitamins.
2.	**Medicinal plant**	*Musa spp.*	Sap obtained from the sheathy leaf base.	Considered to be an antidote for cobra bite.
3.	**Starch**	*Ensete ventricosum* (Ethiopean banana)	The swollen basal parts of leaf sheaths	Used as a source of starch and vitamins.
4.	**Fibre yielding plant**	*Musa textilis* (Manila hemp)	Fibre	Fibre is woven and made into abaca cloth, also used for twine, bagging and wrapping paper.
5.	**Ornamental plant**	*Musa coccinea* (a wild banana species). (*M. acuminata*, *M. velutina* and *M. ornata*) *Ensete ventricosum*	Plant	Have ornamental scarlet flowers. Cultivated as ornamentals
		**Ravenala madagascariensis* (traveller's palm), **Strelitzia reginae* (bird of paradise) and **Heliconia spp*.	Plant	Grown as ornamental plants

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